

Arianna Ornaghi

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EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor of Economics, Hertie School, Germany, 2021-present
British Academy Postdoctoral Research Fellow, University of Warwick, UK, 2019-2021
Research Fellow, University of Warwick, UK, 2017-2019

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, USA, 2017
M.Sc. Economics and Social Sciences, Bocconi University, Italy, 2011
B.Sc. Economics and Social Sciences, Bocconi University, Italy, 2009

AFFILIATIONS

Berlin School of Economics Faculty Member, 2023-present
CEPR Research Affiliate, 2021-present
CESifo Research Network Affiliate, 2024-present
SCRIPTS, co-PI, 2024-present

PUBLICATIONS

Nicola Mastrocchio and Arianna Ornaghi. 2025. "Who Watches the Watchmen? Local News and Police Behavior in the United States". *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, 17 (2): 285-318. *Winner of the European Economic Association Young Economist Award 2020.*

Elliott Ash, Daniel L. Chen, and Arianna Ornaghi. 2024. "Gender Attitudes in the Judiciary: Evidence from US Circuit Courts." *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 16 (1): 314-50.

Abhijit Banerjee, Amy Finkelstein, Rema Hanna, Benjamin A. Olken, Arianna Ornaghi, and Sudarno Sumarto. 2021. "The Challenges of Universal Health Insurance in Developing Countries: Experimental Evidence from Indonesia's National Health Insurance." *American Economic Review*, 111 (9): 3035-63.

Greg Howard and Arianna Ornaghi. 2021. "Closing Time: The Local Equilibrium Effects of Prohibition." *The Journal of Economic History*, 81(3), pp.792-830.

WORKING PAPERS

Johannes Böken, Mirko Draca, Nicola Mastrocchio, and Arianna Ornaghi, 2025. "The Returns to Viral Media: the Case of US Campaign Contributions." CEPR Discussion Paper No. 18337. *R&R at the Journal of the European Economic Association.*

Gregory J. Martin, Nicola Mastrocchio, Joshua McCrain, and Arianna Ornaghi. 2025. "Media Consolidation." CEPR Discussion Paper No. 19503. *R&R at the Review of Economics and Statistics.*

Nicola Mastrocchio, Arianna Ornaghi, Matteo Pograxha, and Stephane Wolton. 2025. "Man Bites Dog: Editorial Choices and Biases in the Reporting of Weather Events." CEPR Discussion Paper No. 18383.

Ornaghi, Arianna. 2019. "Civil Service Reforms: Evidence from U.S. Police Departments."

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Anina Harter and Arianna Ornaghi. "Industrial Disasters and Preferences for Reproductive Rights."

Elisa Facchetti, Arianna Ornaghi, and Eddy Zou. "Police Organization and Police Performance."

TEACHING

Hertie School

Master Thesis Supervision, 2021-present

Economics II Economics & Politics, Hertie School, 2022, 2023, 2025

Economics of Media, Hertie School, 2021-present

Development Economics, Hertie School, 2022-present

University of Warwick

Research in Applied Economics, Warwick, 2018-2022

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

CRC Rationality and Competition, co-PI of Project B08, 2025-2028

Russel Sage Foundation Presidential Grant in Behavioral Economics, with Elliott Ash and Daniel L. Chen (\$35,000), 2019-2021

British Academy Postdoctoral Research Fellowship (£345,000), 2019-2021

British Academy Small Research Grant, with Nicola Mastroianni (£10,000), 2018

CAGE Research Fund Small Grant, with Greg Howard (£5,000), 2017

Sokoloff Dissertation Fellowship, Economic History Association (\$15,000), 2016

Jameel Fellowship in Poverty Alleviation and Development Economics, 2014-2015

Exploratory Travel and Data Grant, Economic History Association, 2015

George and Obie Shultz Fund, 2015-2016

James A. Berkovec Memorial Fund, 2013-2014

MIT Department of Economics Fellowship, 2012-2013

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & INVITED TALKS

2025: University of Lucerne, Economics of Media Bias Workshop, Lancaster Text-as-Data Workshop, Benelux PECO, Transatlantic Economics of Crime Conference (scheduled)

2024: Economics of Media Bias Workshop, Charles University Faculty of Law, Prague University of Economics and Statistics, ifo Institute, Warwick-Princeton-Yale-CEPR Political Economy Symposium, Media Bias and Political Polarization Conference, CESifo Political Economy Workshop, Rockwool Foundation Berlin, University of Potsdam, CEPR Media Plurality Webinar, POLECONUK Webinar

2023: ECONtribute Research Seminar University of Cologne, Yale-TSE Regulating the Digital Economy Conference, Newcastle Business School, ifo Digitalization, IEB University of Barcelona, IEB Political Economy Workshop, CEPR Workshop on Media, Technology, Politics, and Society, ZEW Corporate Taxation and Public Finance

2022: AEA Meetings, Columbia University, Stockholm University, Texas A&M, Federal Communication Commission, IBEO Alghero Workshop, Ludwig Maximilian University, 4th Monash-Warwick-Zurich Text-as-Data Workshop, Paris Empirical Political Economy Seminar

2021: AEA Meetings, University of York, New York University Political Science, New Economic School, Oslo Political Economy Workshop, Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference, IEB Political Economy Workshop, Al Capone Conference, NBER SI Political Economy, London School of Economics PSPE

2020: UEA Textual Analysis Workshop, Economics of Crime Online Seminar, Economics of Discrimination & Disparities Online Seminar, Stockholm Workshop on Diversity and Inclusion, Nottingham Workshop on the Economics of Gender Norms, SoDa Labs Webinar Series, EEA Congress, Zurich Econ & Data Science Reading Group, Deep Learning Trends and Classics Reading Group, University of Rochester Wallis Institute of Political Economy, City University of London, Hertie School

Pre-2019: EMUEA Meetings, PSE Conflict Workshop, University of Glasgow, OWL Economic History Workshop, Warwick Economic History Workshop, Quebec Political Economy Conference, Royal Economic Society, Barcelona GSE Summer Forum, APSA Conference, EALE Annual Conference, Arizona State University School of Politics and Global Studies, Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance, IIES Stockholm University, Bank of Italy, University of British Columbia, IESE Business School, Economic History Association (poster session)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Organizer of the 1st Workshop on the Political Economy of Identity, 2025

Member of the MDS Admission Committee, Hertie School, 2022-present

Member of Recruitment Committees, Hertie School, 2021-2022, 2022-2022, 2023-2024

Organizer of the Political Economy Lunch Series, Hertie School, 2022-2023

Co-organizer of the POLECONUK Webinar Series, 2020-2021

Organizer of the PEPE Research Days, Warwick University, 2017-2021

Referee for: *American Economic Review*, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *Economic Journal*, *ILR Review*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Journal of Economic History*, *Journal of Economic Inequality*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Health Economics*, *Journal of Law, Economics and Organization*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Labour Economics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Social Choice and Welfare*

Last Updated: August 2025.